

Dhāraṇī of Amitābha

Amitābhadhāraṇī · Toh 678 · Derge Kangyur

བཅའོ་ལྷ་འདས་སྐྱོ་བ་མཐའ་ཡས་དེ་བཞིའི་གཤགས་པ་དག་བཅའོ་པ་ཡང་དག་པར་རྒྱོས་པའི་སངས་རྒྱལ་ལ་ཕྱུ་འཆའ་ལོ།

Toh 678 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text devoted to Amitābha, known in Sanskrit as the Amitābha Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Bcom Idan 'das snang ba mtha' yas kyi gzungs, presenting a sacred mantra-formula accompanied by a concise account of its extraordinary purificatory powers. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of Buddhist canonical literature, a category of works centered on potent formulaic phrases held to confer spiritual benefit through recitation. It teaches that even karmic obscurations accumulated over vast spans of time — including the gravest transgressions known as the four root defeats — can be thoroughly purified through reciting this dhāraṇī a relatively small number of times, and that such recitation generates roots of virtue comparable to those produced by a thousand buddhas. As Toh 678 in the Kangyur, it is preserved among the collections of translated texts regarded as buddhavaṇana, or the word of the Buddha, and is associated with the tradition of Amitābha, the buddha of boundless light who figures prominently in Pure Land devotion across the Mahāyāna world.

It is complete.

Homage to the Blessed One, Amitābha, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha.

Tadyathā: Amite, Amitodbhave, Amitasaṃbhave, Amitavikrāntagāminī, Gaganakīrtikare, Sarvakleśakṣayaṃkari, Svāhā.

As for the qualities of this dhāraṇī: know that even the karmic obscurations accumulated over a hundred thousand aeons are exhausted by reciting it three times. If one recites it twenty-one times, even the transgressions of the four root defeats are thoroughly purified of their evil, and roots of virtue are generated equal to those produced by a thousand buddhas.

Translator's Notes

- The passage ends mid-sentence — the source text is cut off after "bskrun" — so the translation faithfully renders up to that point. The mantra syllables are transliterated from Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit and preserved as-is, following standard practice for dhāraṇī passages. The "four root defeats" refers to the four pārājika offenses of full monastic

ordination: killing, stealing, sexual intercourse, and false claims of spiritual attainment.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.